

ARCH-SPEC-2026.V4

PRODUCT ARCHITECTURE & UX SPECIFICATION

Platform Requirements, Information Architecture & User Flows

A comprehensive design and engineering specification detailing the Information Architecture, Onboarding Wireframe Breakdowns, End-to-End User Journeys, and Complete Feature Sitemap for ideakicks.

DOCUMENT VERSION	PRIMARY COLOR	CORE PERSONAS	DOCUMENT DATE
v4.0 (MVP Release)	#082D4D / #6FD179	Creator, Backer, Partner	September 2026

1. Detailed Information Architecture (IA)

Structural taxonomy, global navigation hierarchy, and entity relationships

SYSTEM IA

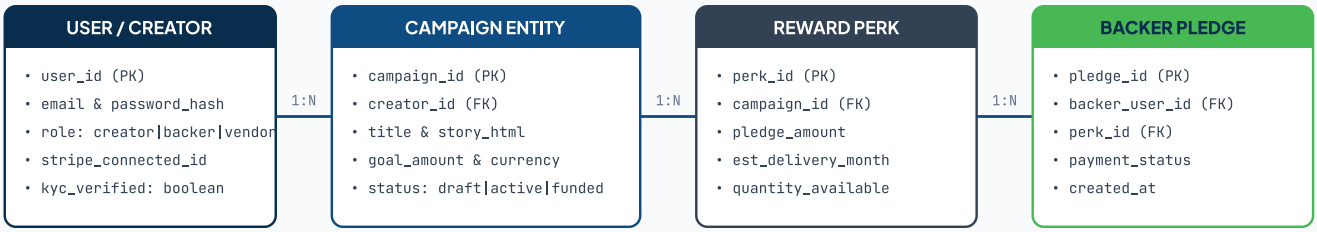
1.1 IA Architectural Principles

- **Persona-Centric Partitioning:** Clean division between Creator (supply), Backer (demand), and Partner (ecosystem) paths.
- **Flattened Navigation Depth:** Critical account actions (Sign out, Settings) accessible in ≤1 click from any route via global header.
- **Predictable Entity Hierarchy:** Category → Campaign → Reward Tier → Backer Pledge → Fulfillment Updates.
- **Transparent Legal & Financials:** Unified zero-surprises pricing (5% platform fee) accessible across all entry funnels.

1.2 Global Site Navigation Hierarchy

```
/ (Home — Persona Portals & Curated Showcase)
├── /explore (Browse, Search, Filter, Categories)
├── /start (Creator Landing Page & Value Props)
│   └── /start/application (4-Step Project Wizard)
├── /backers (Backer Discovery & Protection)
├── /vendors (Partner Ecosystem & Inquiries)
├── /campaign/:id (Campaign View, Rewards & Updates)
│   └── /campaign/:id/back (Backing & Checkout)
├── /dashboard (Overview, Backed, Saved, Campaigns)
│   └── #settings (Account & Security Center)
└── /creator-studio/:id (Creator Management Suite)
```

1.3 Content Model & Entity Relationships



1.4 Category & Project Taxonomy

Primary Category	Subcategories & Topic Clusters	Vetting Criteria & Tags
Technology & Hardware	Consumer Electronics, Audio/IoT, Clean Tech, Robotics, Dev Tools	Working functional prototype required; Bill of Materials review
Design & Craft	Industrial Design, Everyday Carry (EDC), Ceramics, Furniture, Minimal Goods	Sample run feasibility; supplier quotes validated
Games & Interactive	Tabletop/Board Games, Indie Video Games, VR/AR, Game Accessories	Playtest video demo; rulebook draft & art completion
Film & Publishing	Documentary, Narrative Shorts, Independent Books, Graphic Novels	Script/manuscript completion; production budget breakdown
Sustainability & Social	Water Purification, Zero Waste, Community Gardens, Circular Economy	Impact audit; verifiable certifications or lab testing

2. Onboarding Flow Frames: Creator Project Wizard

Interactive step frames for `/start/application` onboarding funnel

CREATOR FUNNEL

The Creator Application Wizard chunks complex crowdfunding setup into 4 progressive, state-validated stages to maximize launch readiness and regulatory compliance.

FRAME 01 · PLAN & SET UP

Step 1: Creator Legal & Banking Setup

Establishes compliance and verifies identity before page creation.

ELIGIBILITY GATES

☑ Age verification (18+ confirmed)
☑ Supported jurisdiction residency

IDENTITY & PAYOUT VERIFICATION

Government ID Upload — VERIFIED
Bank Payout Account — LINKED

PROJECT TAXONOMY

Category: Technology & Hardware → IoT

FRAME 02 · BUILD CAMPAIGN

Step 2: Campaign Page & Reward Tiers

Rich content builder with instant preview validation.

CORE CAMPAIGN ASSETS

- Title & Pitch headline (max 90 chars)
- Hero Image / Video link (16:9 ratio)
- Funding Goal (Flexible: Keep what you raise)

TIERED REWARDS CONFIGURATOR

Early Backer Kit — ₹149 (Est. Dec 2026)
Includes prototype hardware, field guide, worldwide shipping

Founder Edition — ₹299 (Est. Dec 2026)
Includes custom engraving, direct creator Discord channel

FRAME 03 · REVIEW & SUBMIT

Step 3: Pre-Launch Audit & Stripe Connect

System checks, coaching assignment & editorial submission.

PAYMENT ESCROW SYSTEM

Stripe Connect Integration — ACTIVE ESCROW

PRE-LAUNCH CHECKLIST (4/4 COMPLETE)

✔ Verified legal entity & phone number
✔ High-resolution hero media uploaded
✔ At least 1 reward tier configured with delivery date
✔ Transparent risk & challenge disclosures

Review turnaround: 48 hours guaranteed by dedicated human coach.

FRAME 04 · LAUNCH & PROMOTE

Step 4: Launch Approval & Community Sharing

Private draft previews, pre-launch followers & launch trigger.

PRIVATE PREVIEW URL GENERATOR

```
https://ideakicks.com/projects/ether-keyboard?token=draft_preview
```

Shareable to mentors, beta testers and private backers.

EDITORIAL FEEDBACK RECEIVED

"Campaign approved for Public Launch. Coach assigned: Marcus Vance (Hardware lead)."

2.2 User Account Onboarding (`/onboarding`)

Frame A: Persona Intent

Interactive card selector: **Creator** (raising funds), **Backer** (discovering projects), or **Vendor/Partner** (offering manufacturing/services).

Frame B: Interest Clusters

Multi-select tags across 12 sectors (Technology, Design, Games, Sustainability, Film, etc.) to customize dashboard feed.

Frame C: Profile & Handle

Sets display name, public @handle, bio, and avatar. Synchronizes instant redirection to personalized dashboard state.

3. End-to-End User Flows

Step-by-step logic maps for core platform personas

USER JOURNEYS

Flow 1: The Creator Journey (Ideation to Payout)

1. **Discovery & Value Proposition**
   Creator lands on `/start`, reviews flexible funding model (keep what you raise) and 5% platform fee.
2. **Wizard Application (`/start/application`)**
   Completes 4-step wizard: ID verification, media upload, funding target, and tier rewards definition.
3. **Human Review & Coaching (<48h)**
   Editorial team reviews feasibility; 1-on-1 coach assigned to polish story, marketing, and reward pricing.
4. **Public Launch & Campaign Operations**
   Project goes live on `/explore`. Creator manages backers, comments, and updates inside `/creator-studio/:id`.
5. **Campaign Close & Stripe Escrow Release**
   Funds transferred via Stripe Connect. Creator sends regular manufacturing updates to backers until rewards delivered.

Flow 2: The Backer Journey (Discovery to Fulfillment)

1. **Discovery & Filtering**
   Backer navigates `/explore`; searches by keyword, category, funding status, or "Ending Soon" urgency.
2. **Evaluation on Campaign Page (`/campaign/:id`)**
   Reviews video pitch, creator credentials, prototype demos, estimated delivery dates, and transparent risk statements.
3. **Pledge & Flexible Checkout (`/campaign/:id/back`)**
   Selects preferred reward tier; enters shipping destination and payment credentials. Order summary includes taxes & shipping.
4. **Confirmation & Dashboard Tracking**
   Receipt sent to email; project automatically populated into user's `/dashboard` under "Backed Projects" tab.
5. **Reward Fulfillment & Creator Updates**
   Receives notifications for manufacturing milestones, production photos, tracking numbers, and delivery confirmation.

Flow 3: Partner & Vendor Ecosystem Flow

1. **Ecosystem Landing:** Service provider views `/vendors` to explore partnership benefits (manufacturing, fulfillment, legal, hardware prototyping).
2. **Inquiry Submission:** Submits capability profile, factory certifications, minimum order quantities (MOQs), and client references.
3. **Verification Audit:** Ideakicks team vets business standing and quality guarantees.
4. **Directory Listing:** Verified partner added to internal roster; matched directly with creators needing execution help.

Flow 4: Account & Security Management (Header UX)

1. **Global Accessibility:** User profile icon in header displays instant modal menu on click.
2. **One-Click Sign Out:** Direct sign-out button eliminates nested navigation depth.
3. **Direct Settings Routing:** Clicking "Settings" links to `/dashboard#settings`, auto-activating the settings tab.
4. **Profile & Security:** Update bio, change notification frequencies, or export backer data with zero friction.

4. Comprehensive Feature Sitemap

Full inventory of public, authenticated, creator, and legal endpoints

SYSTEM SITEMAP

Route URL	Page Title	Access Level	Primary Features & Components	Primary CTA
`/`	Home	PUBLIC	Hero canvas, 3-path persona grid, curated projects carousel, GlobalCTA	"Explore Projects"
`/explore`	Explore Campaigns	PUBLIC	Category filter pills, live search bar, sorting (popular/newest), project cards	"Back this project"
`/campaign/:id`	Campaign Details	PUBLIC	Hero video/photo, funding meter, story tab, perks sidebar, updates feed	"Back Campaign"
`/campaign/:id/back`	Back Campaign	AUTH / GUEST	Perk selector, pledge customizer, shipping address form, payment gateway	"Confirm & Pledge"
`/campaign/:id/updates`	Campaign Updates	PUBLIC	Chronological creator journal, manufacturing milestones, backer comments	"Post Comment"
`/start`	For Creators Landing	PUBLIC	3 starting stages breakdown, perks grid, 4-step launch timeline, FAQ accordion	"Start Application"
`/start/application`	Project Wizard	CREATOR AUTH	4-stage wizard: KYC setup, campaign page builder, reward tiers, Stripe escrow	"Submit Campaign"
`/creator-studio/:id`	Creator Studio Suite	CREATOR AUTH	Real-time pledge analytics, backer roster CSV export, update publisher, editor	"Publish Update"
`/dashboard`	User Dashboard	AUTH REQUIRED	Overview stats, Backed Projects tab, Saved/Bookmarks tab, My Campaigns tab	"Discover More"
`/dashboard#settings`	Account Settings	AUTH REQUIRED	Profile photo & handle editor, email preferences, notifications, Sign Out	"Save Changes"
`/backers`	For Backers Landing	PUBLIC	Backer protection policies, curated selection process, backer testimonials	"Explore Projects"
`/vendors`	Partner & Vendor Hub	PUBLIC	Directory of approved manufacturing & marketing partners, inquiry lead form	"Apply as Partner"
`/how-it-works`	How It Works	PUBLIC	Detailed breakdown of the ideakicks ecosystem, vetting process, and fees	"Start a Project"
`/pricing`	Pricing & Fees	PUBLIC	Transparent fee breakdown: 5% platform fee, 3%+₹0.30 processing, zero upfront	"Get Started"
`/success-stories`	Success Stories	PUBLIC	Case studies of funded hardware, design, and software creator campaigns	"Launch Yours"
`/about`	About Us	PUBLIC	Company mission, curation ethos, human-reviewed guarantee, team narrative	"Contact Team"
`/contact`	Contact & Support	PUBLIC	Direct contact form for support, enterprise inquiries, mentor partnerships	"Send Message"
`/login` & `/signup`	Auth Modals / Pages	PUBLIC	Email/password auth, Google OAuth, password recovery, session handling	"Sign In / Up"
`/legal`	Legal & Compliance	PUBLIC	Terms of Service, Privacy Policy (GDPR compliant), Cookies, Accessibility	"Review Terms"

Document Approval & Release Notes

Status: Approved for Production Release

System Compliance: Design System v2.4 (Tailwind v4)

Target Platforms: Responsive Web (Desktop & Mobile)